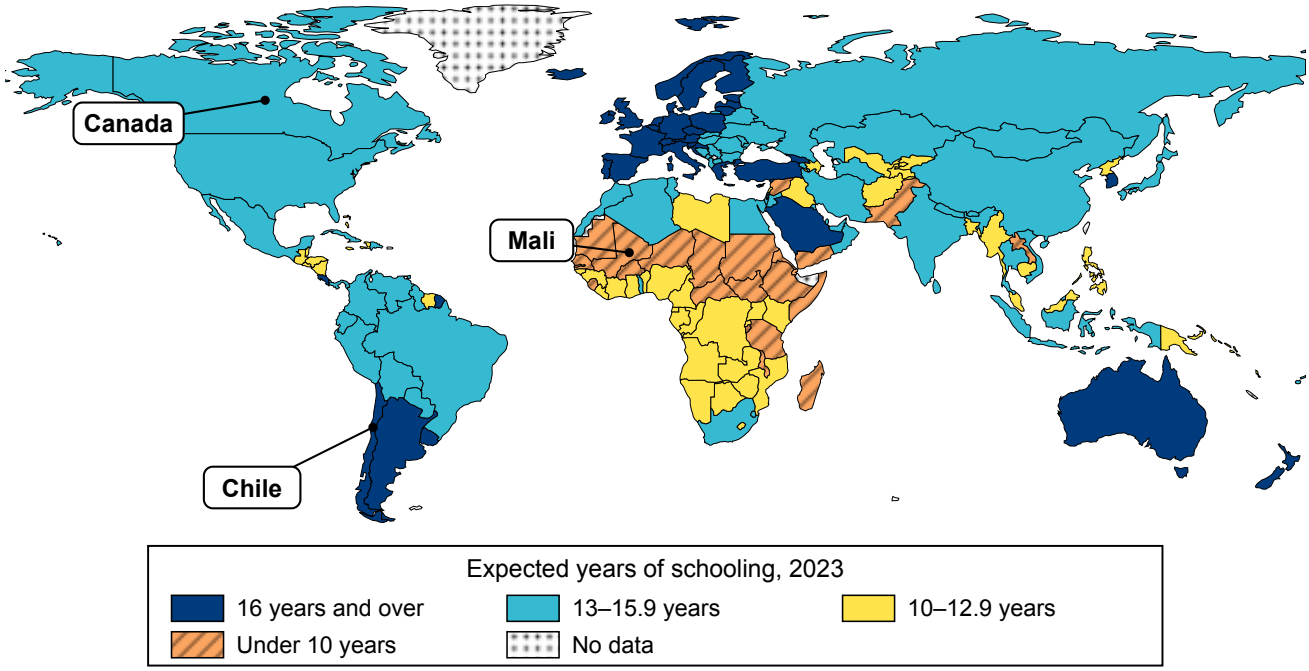
Lesson 4 · Choropleth maps and spatial patterns

Name: _____ Class: _____ Date: _____

Learning intention: We are learning to read choropleth maps and to describe spatial patterns of human wellbeing.
Success criteria: □ I can use the key to identify a country's group. □ I can describe the general pattern, naming at least two regions. □ I can give examples. □ I can identify an exception.

We do: expected years of schooling

Expected years of schooling around the world, 2023



Source: map drawn from UNDP, Human Development Report 2025 (data for 2023). Country outlines: Natural Earth (public domain).

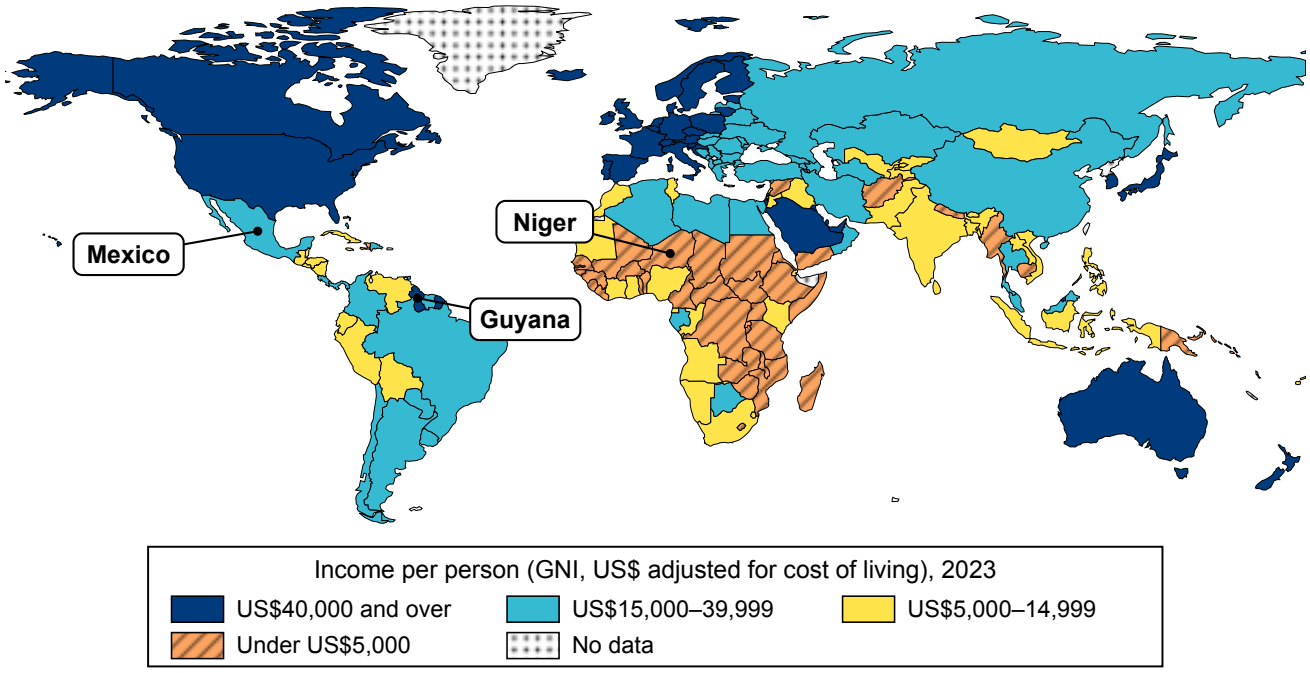
(a) **Identify** the group shown for Mali. *(1 mark)*

(b) **Describe** the spatial pattern. Refer to at least two regions. *(3 marks)*

G: Expected years of schooling is highest in _____ and lowest in _____. **E:** Most of Western Europe, Australia and the south of South America, such as _____, are in the highest group (_____), whereas many countries across Africa's Sahel, such as Mali, are in the lowest group. **E:** However, _____ are in a lower group (13–15.9 years) than most of Europe.

You do: income per person

Income per person around the world, 2023



Source: map drawn from UNDP, Human Development Report 2025 (data for 2023). Country outlines: Natural Earth (public domain).

(a) **Identify** the income group shown for Mexico. *(1 mark)*

(b) **Describe** the spatial pattern of income per person shown on the map. Refer to at least two regions of the world. *(3 marks)*

Extension: Compare this map with the life expectancy map from the lesson. Describe one similarity.

You do: scaffolded version

(a) Mexico's colour is _____. In the key, that colour means _____.

(b) Complete G E E.

G: Income per person is highest in _____ and lowest in _____.

E: For example, _____ are in the highest group (_____), whereas _____, such as Niger, are in the lowest group (_____).

E: However, _____ is an exception, because _____.

North America | Western Europe | sub-Saharan Africa | Japan and South Korea | Australia and New Zealand | Guyana | US$40,000 and over | under US$5,000

Exit ticket (or use a sticky note): name one region in the highest group and one region in the lowest group on the income map.

_____

_____